API2Test — Installation Guide

Installing the API2Test extension for Visual Studio Code

Prerequisites

- **Visual Studio Code 1.74** or later.
- The bundled **Api2Test.vsix** package (in this repository — extension version 0.2.62).
- **Nothing else is needed to import or generate.** To **execute** the generated tests you also need the toolchain for the language you pick — see “First run” below.

Option A — Install from the command line

With the VS Code **code** command on your PATH, run:

```
code --install-extension Api2Test.vsix
```

Restart VS Code if prompted.

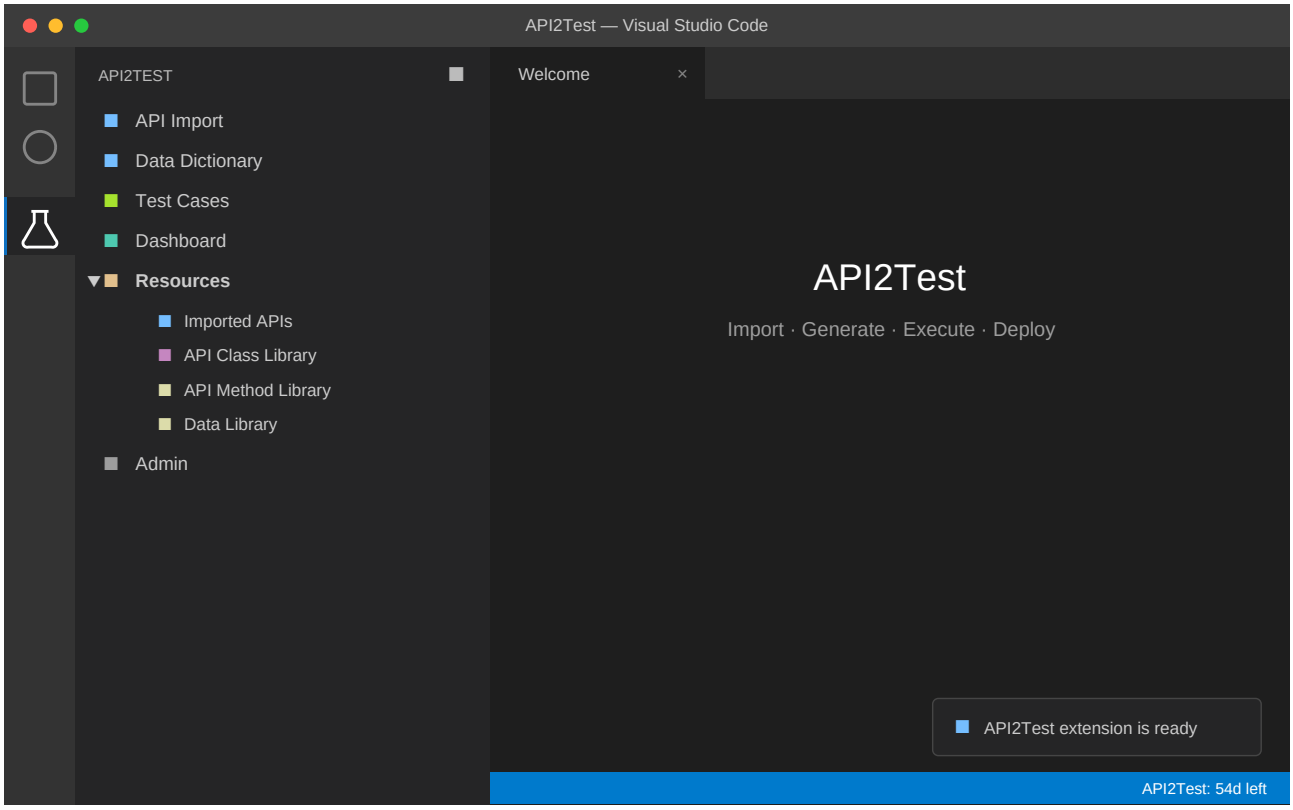
Option B — Install from the VS Code UI

Step	Action
1	Open the Extensions view (Ctrl+Shift+X).
2	Click the “…” (More Actions) menu at the top of the view.
3	Choose “Install from VSIX…”.
4	Select Api2Test.vsix from this repository.
5	Reload VS Code when prompted.

Upgrading from an earlier build? Uninstall the installed API2Test first, then install the new .vsix and reload. Your data directory is left untouched.

Verify the installation

- A **flask icon** appears in the Activity Bar (left edge).
- Clicking it opens the **API2Test** panel with API Import, Data Dictionary, Test Cases, Dashboard, Resources and Admin.
- The status bar (bottom-right) shows the trial countdown, for example **API2Test: 54d left**.



First run — language, sandbox and requirements

The first activation asks **which language to generate in** — C#, TypeScript or Python. The choice is locked for the workspace. It then maps a **sandbox** folder (the default offered is %APPDATA%\Api2Test\sandbox), where Execute builds and runs tests apart from your own source.

A **requirements page** then checks your machine row by row, and reopens at every launch until every row is ✓. Install only the row for the language you picked:

Language	Toolchain (machine-wide)	VS Code extension	One-off setup in the sandbox
C#	.NET SDK, with dotnet on PATH	C# Dev Kit	None — MSTest and Bogus restore on the first build
TypeScript	Node.js LTS + npm	Vitest	npm install in the typescript folder
Python	Python 3 + pip, with python.exe on PATH	Python	pip install -r requirements.txt in the python folder

Trial and licence

Installing starts a **60-day free trial** with every feature unlocked. The status bar counts down, and **Admin** → **Licence** reads it in full (“Trial — 54 days left”, or “Licensed — 192 days left”), turning amber in the last week. When the trial ends the panel asks for a key.

- **API2Test: Enter License Key** — paste your key. It is verified **offline** and stored in VS Code secret storage.
- **API2Test: Show License Status** — licensed (with expiry), trial (days left), or expired.
- **API2Test: Remove License** — drops the stored key; access falls back to the trial clock.

One licence covers both editions — the VS Code extension and the API2Test Desktop app.

Where your data is stored

API2Test keeps its data as JSON files under **~/.vscode/API2Test/data/**. These are created automatically on first run and are never overwritten, so upgrades preserve your applications, libraries, data dictionary and test cases.

Troubleshooting

- **“code” not recognised** — in VS Code run “Shell Command: Install code command in PATH”, or use Option B.
- **The requirements page keeps reopening** — a row is still red. It reopens at every launch until all of them pass.
- **Extension fails to activate** — open Help → Toggle Developer Tools and check the Console, or Output → API2Test.
- **VSIX rejected as incompatible** — confirm VS Code is version 1.74 or later (Help → About).
- **A newly installed VSIX seems to change nothing** — uninstall the old API2Test, then install the new one and reload.